Membership Committee Procedures
Application of Potential Member Processes

Inviting Member's Responsibilities

1. If your guest has potential conflict with ANY member of the group, it is your responsibility to talk to the member about the possible overlap. Do this in a 1-1, in person or over the phone. Handing someone a card is not enough. If the current member justifiably feels there is too much overlap, respect their feelings and don't invite the guest.
2. Explain to your guest that they may overlap with a current member and that member is interested in speaking with them to see if the 2 can work out any overlap. Don't surprise your guest!

Membership Committee Responsibilities

***** In the event the inviting member is on the Membership Committee, it is the responsibility of that member to recuse themselves from the interview process as soon as the applicant has turned in application. If the member does not, it is the responsibility of the head of the MC to ask them to not participate in the application process.*****

1. **Application without overlap of a current member**
    a. Applicant turns application and check over to the head of the MC
    b. Head of MC hands check to Treasurer and meets with MC and applicant to schedule an interview
    c. Applicant is interviewed, MC meets and discusses
    d. Applicant is notified of approval or disapproval
    e. VRG members are notified of new member

**Any member may bring any concerns regarding a potential member to any MC member up until the interview is held. All concerns must be addressed BEFORE the interview is conducted.

2. **Application with overlap of a current member**
    a. Applicant indicates interest in joining VRG.
    b. Head of MC, or any other member of MC, checks with the member with overlap and asks that member to meet with the applicant to determine if the two can work together (member has the right to agree or disagree to meet with the applicant, especially if it is a significant overlap).
    c. Applicant is notified of the potential conflict, and may turn in application, but is informed that it is held and no interview is set until the member returns to the MC and states there is no conflict (possibly on paper so we have a paper trail?)
    d. If there IS conflict, the application is automatically denied and the Head of the MC is tasked with letting the applicant know
    e. If there is NO conflict, the application process can move forward
    f. Applicant is interviewed, MC meets and discusses
    g. Applicant is notified of approval or disapproval
    h. VRG members are notified of new member

** Any member may bring any concerns regarding a potential member to any MC member up until the interview is held. All concerns must be addressed BEFORE the interview is conducted.

3. **Application with concern**
    a. If an application is submitted and a member of VRG has a concern about the applicant, or the applicant's business, that member must approach one of the members of the MC and voice that concern. The MC will in turn investigate the concern, and determine whether or not to move forward with the application
        i. Possible reasons for concern:
            1. Prior business with the applicant that was not conducted professionally
            2. Applicant's attendance or behavior in another organization that a member is also a part of
            3. Knowledge of applicant's unwillingness to abide by the policies and procedures of VRG
    b. If the MC feels the Member's concerns are not justified, and the member is unwilling to move past those concerns, the MC will take the application to the group for a vote. The MC will abide by the vote of the majority.